

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

special. I remember one couple that came as newlyweds—for the third time. No, they didn't come in for the third time. It was the third time they had been remarried—to each other. They had first gotten married in high school, secretly. When they finally told their parents about it, they were both asked to leave their homes.

They tried to make it on their own, but all the odds were against them, and within a year they were separated and then divorced. Paul went into the army for two years, and Faye went home to finish high school.

In the service Paul began to write Faye, and on leaves he and Faye began to date. She finished high school about the time Paul's tour in the army was up, and they were remarried for the second time.

At first they had no problems, but eventually the same old habits got them into financial trouble. They never knew how much they had in their checking account. Faye needed clothes so she charged them; Paul bought a new car—just the normal things that young couples do today. Their parents helped to bail them out a couple of times, but each time the situations got worse. Eventually they were divorced for a second time.

Paul earned his high school equivalency diploma and was determined to go to college. He was working his way through when he bumped into Faye again almost three years later during a school break. They began to see each other infrequently and within a year were dating regularly. Paul had become very active in a campus ministry and had committed his life to Christ. During a rally, Faye committed her life to Christ and they decided to get remarried, for the third time.

Only this time they realized they lacked the training to handle their finances properly and determined they would not commit the same mistakes again. In the Lord's timing, I was doing a seminar at the college on personal finances for students. Paul couldn't have been more excited if someone had given him a million dollars. The areas I discussed with the students were an exact parallel to what he and Faye had experienced twice before. They had come out of middle-class fam-